- Discolouration.
- Fat separates out into clumps.
- Milk curdles when heated.
- Butter tastes rancid.
- Cheese and curd develop off odour and mould growth.

4. ***Meat and poultry:*** Spoilt meat shows the following signs
- Discolouration.
- Putrid smell.
- Slimy appearance and feel.

Organ meats such as liver, kidney and brain are more perishable than muscle meat due to the presence of fat.

5. ***Fish:*** Spoilt fish shows the following signs:
- Dull or sunken eyes.
- Gills are grey or green.
- Off odour.
- Flesh separates from bone and is flabby.
- Loose scales.
- Shellfish claws and tail lose their spring.

6. ***Eggs:*** Spoilt eggs will float when dropped in water. The signs of spoilt egg are:
- Cracked shell.
- Leaking contents.
- Exposed egg yolk.
- Eggs should be checked for blood spot, meat spot, foul odour or other contaminations.

DO YOU KNOW?

Do we get oxygen from microbes?
Yes. Microbes generate at least half the oxygen we breathe.

7. ***Cooked foods:*** Cooked foods must be consumed immediately and the left overs should be stored carefully. Cooked foods have high risk of getting spoilt.

8. ***Canned foods:*** Generally canned foods have longer shelf life and the chance of getting spoilage is possible when bacteria enters the can. Sometimes the acid from food reacts with the iron of the container and the canned foods get spoiled. The signs of spoilage in canned foods are:



▲ Plate 8.11 Sign of Leakage

- Puffy, swollen appearance of cans.
- Leaky, corroded or rusty cans.
- Contents spurt out when the can is opened.
- Contents smell putrid.
- Brine or syrup looks cloudy, bubbly, slimy or mouldy.
- Contents are discoloured.

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